

May nothing evil cross this door

Text: Louis Untermeyer, 1923

Music: Robert N. Quaile, b. 1867

OLDBRIDGE 88.84

The musical score is written for a single voice in 3/4 time, with a key signature of three flats (B-flat, E-flat, A-flat). The melody is simple and hymn-like, with a final double bar line at the end of the fourth line. The lyrics are arranged in four stanzas, each corresponding to a line of music. The first stanza has four numbered verses. The second and third stanzas have four verses each. The fourth stanza has four verses. The lyrics are as follows:

1 May noth - ing e - vil cross this door,
2 By faith made strong, the raft - ers will
3 Peace shall walk soft - ly through these rooms,
4 With laugh - ter drown the rau - cous shout,
and may ill for - tune nev - er pry
with - stand the bat - tering of the storm.
touch - ing our lips with ho - ly wine,
and, though these shel - tering walls are thin,
a - bout these win - dows; may the roar
This hearth, though all the world grow chill,
till ev - 'ry cas - ual cor - ner blooms
may they be strong to keep hate out
and rain go by.
will keep you warm.
in - to a shrine.
and hold love in.